

6 | THE PLAIN DEALER | Thursday, February 20, 2003

BOYS SECTIONAL-DISTRICT PREVIEW: DIVISION I

Cleveland South

Where: Cleveland South High, 7415 Broadway Ave., Cleveland. Call 216-641-0410.

Seeded teams: 1. Cleveland Heights; 2. Warren Harding; 3. Shaker Heights; 4. Cleveland East.

Other teams: Bedford, East Tech, Euclid, Garfield Heights, Warren Howland, Cleveland John F. Kennedy, Lincoln-West, Maple Heights, Twinsburg.

When: Semifinals, March 5 and 6 at 6:30 p.m.; finals, March 8 at 1:30 p.m.

Favorite: Cleveland Heights is playing with poise and confidence. In 12 of the last 13 seasons, either Cleveland Heights or Shaker Heights has cut down the nets at South.

Dark horse: Maple Heights has played some of the area's best teams tough. Shaw, Warrensville Heights and Collinwood can attest to the Mustangs' spirit.

X-factor: Is this the season Warren Harding finally looks comfortable on the South floor? The Big House on Broadway hasn't been kind to the Raiders' athletes.

Euclid

Where: Euclid High, 711 E. 222nd St., Euclid. Call 216-797-7805.

Seeded teams: 1. Shaw; 2. Glenville; 3. Mentor; 4. Brush.

Other teams: Chardon, Cleveland South, Collinwood, Eastlake North, Geneva, Lakeside, Madison, Mayfield, Riverside, Willoughby South.

When: Semifinals, March 5 and 6 at 7 p.m.; finals, March 8 at 7:30 p.m.

Favorite: Mentor. The Cardinals have Eddie Zienkowski and several versatile players. Ignore their few defeats. Mentor was 9-11 before charging to a regional final last season.

Darkhorse: Madison. The Blue Streaks' array of outside shooters is capable of pulling an upset.

X-factor: Perseverance. When Shaw's Cardinals stick to the basics, they're one of Ohio's top teams.

Midview

Where: Midview High, 38199 Capel Road, Grafton. Call 440-748-5231.

Seeded teams: 1. Olmsted Falls; 2. St. Edward; 3. Elyria; 4. Brunswick.

Other teams: Admiral King, Avon Lake, Cloverleaf, Lakewood, North Olmsted, North Ridgeville, Southview, Am-

herst, Westlake.

When: Semifinals, March 5 and 6 at 7 p.m.; finals, March 8 at 7 p.m.

Favorite: St. Edward has a tournament-tested nucleus, including four mainstays from last year's Final Four squad.

Dark horse: Providing Lakewood has put its frustration to bed, a district title is far from a long shot.

X-factor: Elyria's all-state senior guard, Robert Nelson, can force any team to adjust.

Olmsted Falls / Baldwin-Wallace

Where: Sectional semifinals and finals will be played at Olmsted Falls High, 26939 Bagley Road, and district semifinals and finals will be played at B-W's Ursprung Gymnasium on Bagley Road in Berea. Call 440-546-9395.

Seeded teams: 1. St. Ignatius; 2. North Royalton; 3. Solon; 4. Rhodes.

Other teams: Berea, Breckville-Broadview Heights, John Marshall, Midpark, Midview, Normandy, Parma, Strongsville, Valley Forge.

When: Semifinals, March 4 at 6:30 and 8 p.m.; finals, March 7 at 7:30 p.m.

Favorite: St. Ignatius' last setback at B-W came at the hands of Brecksville in 1997.

Dark horse: Strongsville. Kyle Koncz is a player, and Joe Lynch is a top-notch coach who has been around the tournament trail.

X-factor: Get into St. Ignatius' bench early, and you have a legitimate shot.

Copley

Where: Copley High, 3807 Ridgewood Drive, Copley. Call 330-668-3233.

Seeded teams: 1. Wadsworth; 2. Stow; 3. Barberton; 4. Wooster.

Other teams: Akron Garfield, Cuyahoga Falls, Ellet, Firestone, Hudson, Green, Kent Roosevelt, Medina, Nordonia.

When: Semifinals, March 4 and 5 at 7:30 p.m.; finals, March 7 at 7:30 p.m.

Favorite: Stow. Strength of schedule has a lot to do with it, but not as much as its style of play.

Dark horse: Cuyahoga Falls. The Black Tigers will have a golden opportunity if they can figure out a way to get around Stow.

X-factor: Rotation. Wadsworth coach John Martin has adopted a full-scale substitution rotation of five players replacing five others.

Bulldog without a bark



CHUCK CROW | THE PLAIN DEALER

Dan Binggeli has helped spark Olmsted Falls to an 18-1 record by averaging more than 19 points, six rebounds, five assists and five steals.

Olmsted Falls' Binggeli leads by example

EDDIE DWYER
Plain Dealer Reporter

Dan Binggeli is a quiet, unassuming kid.

But when it comes to the game he loves, the Olmsted Falls standout knows exactly how to express himself.

"I try to constantly move without the ball and make everybody around me better," said the All-Southwestern Conference and all-district selection.

Binggeli's ability to make those around him succeed is substantiated by the team's record (18-1) and top-10 state ranking.

Displaying fluid moves to the

basket, a potent outside jumper and sound instincts at both ends of the court, the 6-2, 170-pound junior two-guard is averaging more than 19 points and more than six rebounds, five assists and five steals.

"What he is, in a nutshell, is an all-around player," said Olmsted Falls basketball coach Pat Donahue. "He can shoot it, he can handle it, and his teammates know that if there are rebounds to be had, he'll be there."

"Dan is not very vocal. But he lets his actions speak loudly. He's a solid person who is always respectful to people."

Although Donahue's admiration for Binggeli is genuine, the veteran coach doesn't hesitate to point out that his guard needs to get stronger and improve his footwork on defense.

"Other than that, Dan has very quick hands, has a very nice shot

and sees the court extremely well," Donahue said. "And the nice thing is that he is the type of kid who is going to keep working. I don't have to worry about that."

Binggeli, who also is a short-stop on the varsity baseball team, has been working at it since the third grade, when he began playing CYO sports at St. Mary of the Falls. Part of his routine includes coming to school in the early hours and shooting around with Bulldogs junior forward Steve Gansey.

Binggeli, who is referred to by rival SWC coaches as the Bulldogs' steadying influence, said he tries "never to get frustrated."

For Olmsted Falls' quiet man, the goal is to let the game flow to him.

To reach this Plain Dealer reporter: edwyer@plained.com, 216-999-4677

REGIONAL / STATE TOURNAMENT SCHEDULES

REGIONAL TOURNAMENTS

at Univ. of Akron
March 12
Copley district winner vs. Cleveland South district winner, 7

March 13
Euclid district winner vs. Canton district winner, 7

March 15
Championship, 7:30
at Univ. of Toledo

March 12
Bowling Green district winner vs. Midview district winner, 6:15
Baldwin-Wallace district winner

vs. Elida district winner, 8
March 15
Championship, 7:30
at Columbus Fairgrounds

March 12
Dayton district #5 winner vs. Columbus district #2 winner, 7

March 13
Columbus district #3 winner vs. Columbus district #1 winner, 7

March 15
Championship, 7:30
at Cincinnati/Xavier Univ.

March 13
Dayton district #4 winner vs. Dayton district #3 winner,

6:15
Dayton district #1 winner vs. Dayton district #2 winner, 8

March 15
Championship, 7:30

STATE TOURNAMENT

at Value City Arena, Columbus
March 21
Cincinnati regional winner vs. Akron regional winner, 6
Columbus regional winner vs. Toledo regional winner, 9
March 22
State championship, 8:30